A repository is an interview before the interview.

How hiring managers read your GitHub — and what they're actually judging.

10 slides · swipe

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They read the repo, not the CV.

By the time someone opens your GitHub, they've filtered you by everything else. The repo is where the doubt dies or confirms itself — usually within two minutes.

Your repo is the interview's first five questions.

What separates a profile from a pattern.

01 Runnable instructions that actually work on a clean machine

02 Tests that express failure modes, not just happy paths

03 Commit history with real iteration, not a single dump

04 A README that says what breaks and what you did about it

05 One real incident postmortem, honestly told

Anyone can have code. Few can have judgment.

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What makes a hiring manager close the tab.

01 Forks of famous projects with one-letter commits

02 A TODO list from three years ago, untouched

03 README that says nothing about what it does or why

04 Secret keys or credentials anywhere in history

05 No evidence of ownership — only toys

Three of these and your CV is just paper.

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What my GitHub signals.

12+

real projects across Python, TS, Java, Rust and Lua

62

MCP tools in opencode-chrome, extracted from real incidents

1

game server network repaired in public, failures included

github.com/Mukller — judge the failures, not the polish.

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If you're starting from zero.

01 Pick one real problem you solve daily — not a tutorial

↓

02 Write the README before the code — force the why

↓

03 Ship it broken, then fix it publicly — evidence of iteration

↓

04 Add one postmortem — the single strongest trust signal there is

One authentic repo beats ten polished clones.

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What they're really screening for.

They don't want to hire your repositories. They want to hire the judgment inside them.

A repo is a portfolio of decisions, not of files.

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If you're early in your career.

Nobody expects a senior's blast radius from a junior. What they expect — and rarely find — is evidence that you finish things, document the mess, and fix what you shipped.

Finish. Document. Fix.
In that order.

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If you're senior, here's the bar.

Show the system you owned, the incident you ran, the decision you reversed with evidence. A senior's GitHub without postmortems reads as a contractor's list, not a leader's record.

**Seniority is documented scars,
not framework lists.**

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REPOS · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Check your repos against this tonight.

Three questions per repo: Can a stranger run it? Can they see you fix things? Can they find the incident? If not — that's the work. antonpetnitsky.com

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